

Section C

For this section, students will need to see a live production of the chosen play and evaluate the performance elements that contributed to their understanding of the director's interpretation in this performance.

Students may consider and make notes on the following performance elements:

- acting techniques including verbal and non-verbal communication
- design elements including set and staging, costume and makeup, lighting and sound
- the interpretation of the play in the performance they see.

Students will need to research the original performance conditions of the play that they see live and be able to make connections between the two time periods. They should consider and understand the social, cultural and historical context of the play in relation to its performance history as witnessed in the live performance in relation to what it might have been like in its original performance.

Students' notes on the play in performance and its historical context will be compiled into a Research Notes document that will inform their thinking in relation to the question they will answer in this section of Unit 4.

- The Research Notes document may include drawings, sketches and diagrams but no pre-published material and should be no more than 1000 words in length.

4.4 Assessment guidance

Sections A and B

In this section, students will be required to relate their ideas for the whole play to an extract set in the examination and to articulate their knowledge of the social, cultural, and/or historical contexts of the play in relation to their proposed production.

Section A is about the process and its focus is on rehearsal in relation to the given extract.

Section B is about the performance and its focus is on the interpretation in relation to the question.

Evidence in relation to this section will come from appropriate use of the language of performance to demonstrate understanding of the role of the director.

Section A requires that students demonstrate a full understanding of the process of rehearsing a play for performance with specific reference to the given extract and appropriate and demonstrable rehearsal techniques/methods.

Section B requires that students demonstrate a full understanding of the influence a director may have over a production of the play in relation to the focus of the question. The students should be able to consider in detail the performers, designers and interpretation in relation to the intended impact on the audience and be able to explore this fully and with confidence.